AWS Systems Manager — Console Dashboard Wise Important Interview Questions & Answers



1. What is AWS Systems Manager?
Answer:
AWS Systems Manager is a service used to manage and operate AWS resources such as EC2 instances.
It allows us to remotely manage servers, run commands, automate tasks, store configuration parameters, and troubleshoot instances.
It reduces the need to connect to servers manually using traditional methods.
For example:
Suppose we have 20 EC2 servers and need to install a package on all of them.
Instead of connecting to each server individually, we can use Systems Manager Run Command to execute the command on multiple servers.
This makes server management faster and easier.
Example:
Systems Manager
↓
EC2 Instances
↓ ↓ ↓
EC2-1 EC2-2 EC2-3
↓
Run Command
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Systems Manager = Manage AWS servers without manually logging into each server

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2. What is Fleet Manager?
Answer:
Fleet Manager provides a console-based way to view and manage managed nodes such as EC2 instances.
It allows administrators to inspect files, processes, users, and other information on managed instances.
It is useful when we want to troubleshoot or manage servers from the AWS Console.
For example:
Suppose an EC2 server is having an issue and we want to inspect its files or running processes.
Instead of opening a separate SSH session, we can use Fleet Manager from Systems Manager.
This gives us a centralized management view.
Example:
AWS Console
↓
Systems Manager
↓
Fleet Manager
↓

EC2 Instance
↓
Files / Processes / Users
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Fleet Manager = Manage and inspect EC2 servers from Console

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3. What is Session Manager?
Answer:
Session Manager allows us to connect to managed EC2 instances through the AWS Console or CLI without opening inbound SSH or RDP ports.
It uses the Systems Manager Agent and IAM permissions to establish the session.
This improves security because we can avoid exposing port 22 or 3389 to the internet.
For example:
Suppose our Linux EC2 instance has no public SSH access.
If SSM Agent is installed and the instance has the required IAM role, we can open a Session Manager session from the AWS Console.
We can then work on the server through the terminal.
Example:
AWS Console
↓
Session Manager
↓
SSM Agent
↓
EC2
↓
Terminal
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Session Manager = Secure server access without SSH port

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4. What is Run Command?
Answer:
Run Command allows us to execute commands or scripts on one or many managed EC2 instances.
We can select instances using tags or specific instance IDs and run the required command remotely.
It is useful for software installation, configuration changes, troubleshooting, and administration.
For example:
Suppose we need to install Nginx on 10 EC2 instances.
Instead of logging into every server, we can send one command through Run Command.
Systems Manager executes the command on the selected instances.
Example:
Systems Manager
↓
Run Command
↓
EC2-1 EC2-2 EC2-3
↓
Install Nginx
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Run Command = Run commands on multiple EC2 servers remotely

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5. What is Automation in Systems Manager?
Answer:
Systems Manager Automation helps us automate common operational tasks on AWS resources.
We can use predefined or custom automation runbooks to perform multiple steps automatically.
It is useful for maintenance, troubleshooting, recovery, and repetitive administrative tasks.
For example:
Suppose an EC2 instance needs a standard recovery procedure.
Instead of manually performing every step, we can create an Automation runbook that performs those steps automatically.
This reduces manual work and operational errors.
Example:
Automation
↓
Runbook
↓
Step 1
↓
Step 2
↓
Step 3
↓
Task Completed

Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Automation = Automate operational tasks using runbooks

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6. What is Parameter Store?
Answer:
Parameter Store is a Systems Manager feature used to store configuration values and parameters.
It can store normal strings as well as encrypted SecureString parameters.
Applications can retrieve these values instead of hard-coding configuration information inside application code.
For example:
Suppose our application needs a database endpoint and an API configuration value.
We can store those values in Parameter Store and allow the application to retrieve them when required.
Sensitive values can be stored as SecureString.
Example:
Application
↓
Parameter Store
↓
DB Endpoint / Config
↓
Application
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Parameter Store = Central place for application configuration

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7. What is Application Manager?
Answer:
Application Manager helps us view and manage the resources that belong to an application from one place.
It can provide an application-centric view of AWS resources and operational information.
This is useful when an application contains multiple AWS resources.
For example:
Suppose our application contains EC2, Lambda, CloudFormation, and other resources.
Instead of checking every service separately, Application Manager can provide an application-level view.
This makes application operations easier.
Example:
Application Manager
↓
Application
/ | \
EC2 Lambda CloudFormation
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Application Manager = Manage application resources from one view

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8. What is Change Manager?
Answer:
Change Manager helps organizations plan, approve, and track operational changes to AWS resources.
It provides a controlled process for requesting and approving changes before they are performed.
It is useful for reducing risks caused by unplanned production changes.
For example:
Suppose we need to change the configuration of production EC2 servers.
Instead of directly making the change, we can create a change request and follow the required approval process.
After approval, the change can be implemented.
Example:
Change Request
↓
Approval
↓
Change
↓
Production
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Change Manager = Plan + Approve + Track changes

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9. What is Change Calendar?
Answer:
Change Calendar helps us define when operational changes are allowed or restricted.
It can be used to identify approved maintenance periods and avoid risky changes during important business periods.
It helps teams coordinate production changes.
For example:
Suppose our company does not allow production changes during weekends or a major sales event.
We can define those periods in the change calendar.
Teams can then plan changes around the approved windows.
Example:

Change Calendar
↓
Approved Window
↓
Maintenance
↓
Production
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Change Calendar = Decide when changes can happen

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10. What are Systems Manager Documents?
Answer:
Systems Manager Documents define the actions and steps that Systems Manager can perform.
They are commonly used with Run Command, Automation, and other Systems Manager capabilities.
AWS provides predefined documents, and we can also create custom documents for specific requirements.
For example:
Suppose we want to install a software package on EC2 instances.
We can use an appropriate Systems Manager document that defines the installation steps.
Run Command can then execute that document on selected instances.
Example:
SSM Document
↓
Instructions
↓
Run Command / Automation
↓
EC2
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
SSM Document = Instructions for Systems Manager

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11. What is Quick Setup?
Answer:
Quick Setup helps us quickly configure common Systems Manager capabilities across AWS resources.
It can automate configurations such as enabling management features and applying required settings to instances.
This is useful when we want to configure many resources consistently.
For example:
Suppose we have many EC2 instances and want to configure Systems Manager management consistently.
Instead of configuring each instance manually, we can use Quick Setup to apply the required configuration.
This saves administrative effort.
Example:
Quick Setup
↓
Configuration
↓
Multiple EC2 Instances
↓ ↓ ↓
EC2-1 EC2-2 EC2-3
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Quick Setup = Quickly configure Systems Manager across resources

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12. What is OpsCenter?
Answer:
OpsCenter helps operations teams manage operational issues and incidents from a centralized location.
It creates and tracks operational work items called OpsItems.
Teams can use these items to investigate problems and coordinate remediation.
For example:
Suppose an EC2 instance has a production issue.
An OpsItem can be created to record the problem, investigation details, and remediation actions.
The operations team can track the issue until it is resolved.
Example:
Problem
↓
OpsCenter
↓
OpsItem
↓
Investigation
↓
Resolution
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
OpsCenter = Central place to manage operational issues

13. What is Explorer?
Answer:
Systems Manager Explorer provides an operations dashboard for viewing information about AWS resources and operational data.
It can help teams understand operational issues, compliance information, and resource status from a centralized view.
This is useful for getting an overall operational picture.
For example:
Suppose a company manages many EC2 instances across AWS.
Instead of checking each instance separately, Explorer can provide consolidated operational information.
The team can use that information to identify areas requiring attention.
Example:
Multiple AWS Resources
↓
Explorer
↓
Operational View
↓
Issues / Status
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Explorer = Overall operational view

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14. What is Resource Groups?
Answer:
Resource Groups allow us to group AWS resources based on tags or other criteria.
This makes it easier to manage related resources together.
Systems Manager can use resource groups to target resources for management operations.
For example:
Suppose our production application has 10 EC2 instances tagged Environment=Production.
We can create a resource group for those instances and use it when performing management operations.
This avoids selecting each instance manually.
Example:
Tag: Environment=Production
↓
Resource Group
↓
EC2-1 EC2-2 EC2-3
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
Resource Group = Group related AWS resources together

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15. Why is SSM Agent important?
Answer:
SSM Agent is software that runs on managed instances and allows Systems Manager to communicate with them.
It enables capabilities such as Session Manager, Run Command, and other Systems Manager operations.
The instance also needs the required IAM permissions and network connectivity for Systems Manager to work properly.
For example:
Suppose we want to connect to an EC2 instance using Session Manager.
The instance must be properly configured as a managed node, including the required SSM Agent and permissions.
Then Systems Manager can communicate with the instance.
Example:
Systems Manager
↓
SSM Agent
↓
EC2 Instance
↓
Management
Simple ga gurthupettuko:
SSM Agent = Bridge between Systems Manager and EC2